

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 727

By Moon

A RESOLUTION to urge the United States Congress to enact legislation to bring home the USS *Intrepid* sailors entombed in Libya.

WHEREAS, on September 4, 1804, thirteen United States sailors on board the USS *Intrepid* were killed when their explosive-packed ship blew up prematurely during an attack on the harbor of Tripoli, Libya, during the first Barbary War; and

WHEREAS, the sailors' remains were discovered onshore the next day, abused by the enemy and partially devoured by a pack of stray dogs before U.S. Navy prisoners in Tripoli were allowed to bury the men; and

WHEREAS, more than two centuries later, those American heroes lie buried in a hostile land, and their tombs have often been desecrated and vandalized; and

WHEREAS, the remains of five of the sailors are located in Protestant Cemetery in Tripoli, Libya, and the remains of eight of the sailors are located near the walls of the Tripoli Castle in Tripoli, Libya; and

WHEREAS, the federal government should take whatever steps are necessary to exhume the remains of these American heroes, transport such remains to an appropriate forensics laboratory for identification, if possible, and subsequently for interment with full military funeral and burial in an appropriate veterans cemetery or Arlington National Cemetery at the Tomb of the Unknowns; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby urge the United States Congress to enact legislation and policies to bring home the USS *Intrepid* sailors entombed in Libya.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be transmitted to the Speaker and the Clerk of the United States House of Representatives, the President and Secretary of the United States Senate, and each member of the Tennessee Congressional delegation.